



KIRIBATI

DISABILITY FACT SHEET



Pacific
Community
Communauté
du Pacifique



Source: Kiribati 2020 Population and Housing Census

DEMOGRAPHICS



99,466

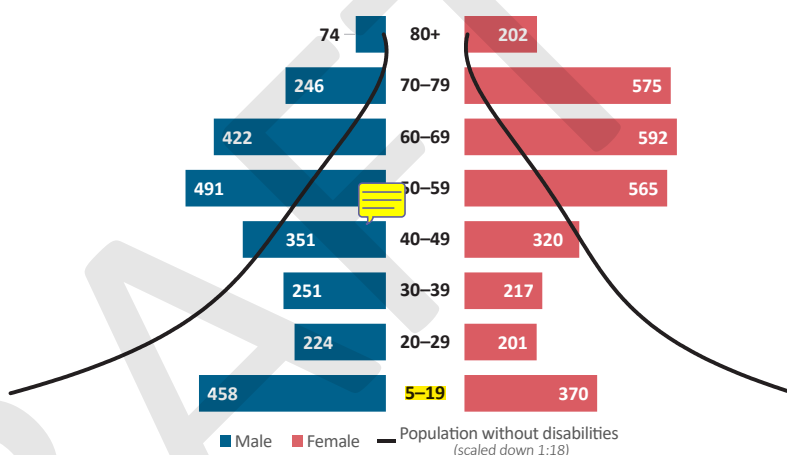
Population aged 5+ (2020)



5,559

Population aged 5+
with disabilities (2020)

Kiribati population is slightly dominated by females



Distribution of the population aged 5+
with disabilities by sex

Median age (years)

26

People without disabilities

53

People with disabilities

National Sex Ratio

97

(97 males for 100 females)

83

Among people with disabilities
(83 males for 100 females)

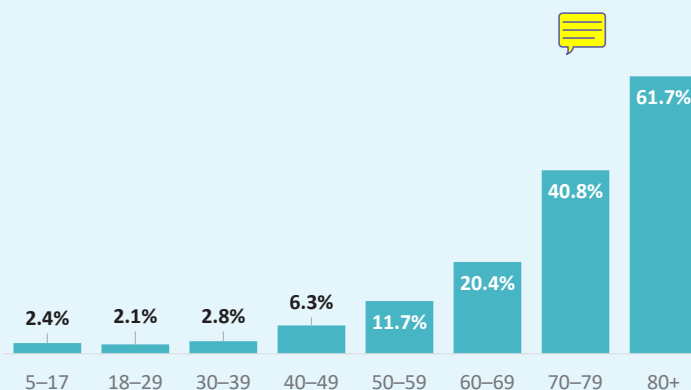


Females are more likely to
have disabilities¹ than males

PREVALENCE

In 2020, 5.6% of people aged 5+ have
disabilities (3.1% in 2015)

Prevalence of disability increases with age,
from 2.4% among those aged 5-17 to 61.7%
among those aged 80+



Prevalence of any disability of the population aged 5+
by age group

National level 5+ years prevalence by disability type distribution of people with disabilities

5.6% Total
5.2% Males
6.0% Females

	Total	Males	Females
Walking	2.9%	2.5%	3.3%
Seeing	1.4%	1.3%	1.5%
Hearing	1.2%	1.2%	1.3%
Remembering	1.2%	1.0%	1.4%
Selfcare	1.0%	1.1%	1.0%
Communication	1.0%	1.1%	1.0%

Prevalence of types of disabilities in the population aged 5+ by sex

EDUCATION

National level 15+ who ever attended school

Add here :Without disability

98.0%
Males

98.4%
Females

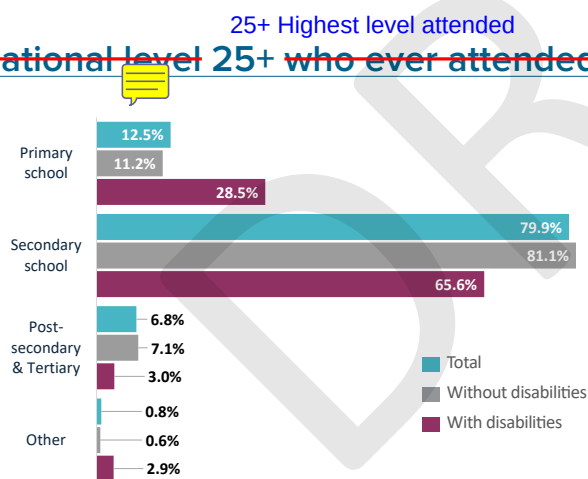
With disabilities

89.2%
Males

86.4%
Females

There is disparity in school attendance due to disability status

National level 25+ who ever attended school



People with disabilities aged 25+ are less likely to have attended secondary school and tertiary level education

National level 15+ who can read and write (Literacy)

People aged 15+ with disabilities are more likely to be illiterate

5.9% Total
4.4% Without disabilities
26.9% With disabilities

Percentage of adults (15+) who are illiterate

Youth aged 15–24 with disabilities are more likely than adults to be illiterate

4.5% Total
3.8% Without disabilities
37.8% With disabilities

Percentage of youth (15–24) who are illiterate

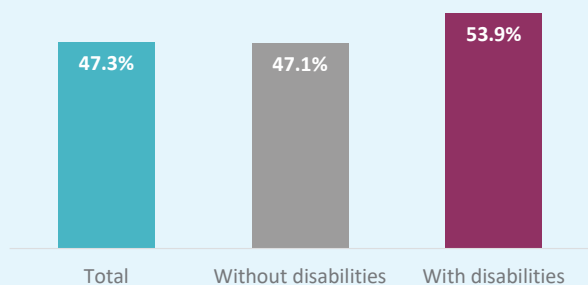


There is literacy equality between males and females regardless of disability status

EMPLOYMENT

National level 15–24 not in Education, nor in Employment or Training (NEET)

In 2020, nearly 1 in 2 youths aged 15–24 are neither in employment nor in education

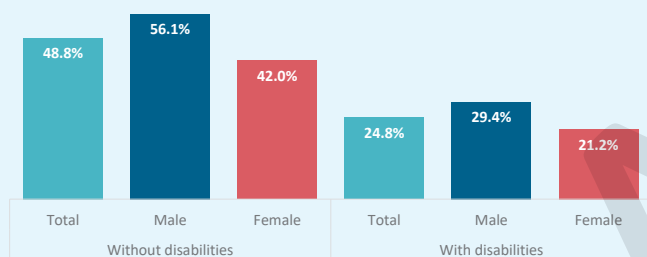


~~Youth (15–24) NEET rate~~

Youth aged 15–24 with disabilities are more likely than their peers without disabilities to be NEET

National level 15+ labour force participation rate

~~The labour force participation rate is 47.2%~~



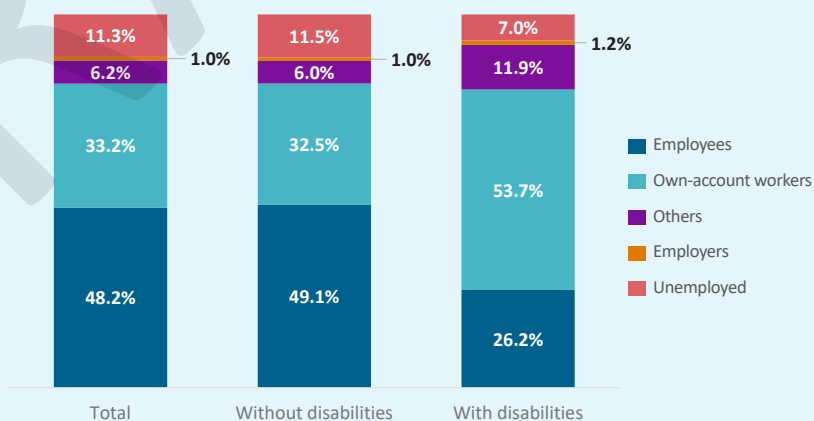
~~15+ Labour force participation rate (LFPR)³~~

People aged 15+ with disabilities are 24 points behind people without disabilities in participation in the labour force

~~Females with disabilities (21.2%) are less likely to participate in the labour force (Males with disabilities: 29.4%)~~



When classified as in the labour force, 1 in 2 people with disabilities worked on their own account



~~15+ in the labour force employment status~~

WATER AND SANITATION

People aged 5+ with disabilities have slightly less access to improved water sources⁴ in the household



74.2% Total 74.4% Without disabilities 71.1% With disabilities

~~Percentage of people aged 5+ with access to an improved water drinking source~~



People aged 5+ with disabilities are less likely than others to have access to improved sanitation facilities⁵



Percentage of people aged 5+ with access to improved sanitation facilities



There is no gender gap in access to drinking water sources and sanitation facilities regardless of disability status

ACCESS TO INTERNET

Less than 4 in 10 people aged 10+ had access to Internet the week before the interview in 2020



Slightly more than 1 in 10 people with disabilities had access to Internet the week before the interview in 2020



Percentage of people aged 10+ with access to Internet



Among those who had access to internet, most people (82.9%) had access to internet at home regardless of disability status

INFO BOX

People with disabilities are more likely to live in households within the lowest quintile of wealth: the disability prevalence rate is 7.1% in the lowest quintile vs 4.3% in the highest quintile

DEFINITIONS

1 **Disabilities:** The Washington Group Short Set on Functioning (WG-SS) identifies persons 5+ years, who declare having difficulties in at least one of the six core domains of functioning: seeing, hearing, walking, cognition, self care, and communication. Responses include 'No difficulty', 'Some difficulty', 'A lot of difficulty', and 'Cannot do at all'. Disability is classified according to whether a respondent has at least 'a lot of difficulty' on at least one of the six questions.

2 **Adults:** People aged 15+ are counted as adults.

3 **Labour Force Participation Rate:** Percentage of people aged 15+ who are working or looking for work on the working age population.

4 **Improved water sources:** The WHO defines an improved water source as one that is accessible on premises, available when needed and free from faecal and priority chemical contamination. Improved water sources include piped water, boreholes or tubewells, protected dug wells, protected springs, rainwater, and packaged or delivered water.

5 **Improved sanitation facilities:** The WHO and the UNICEF define an improved sanitation facility as one that likely hygienically separates human excreta from human contact. Improved sanitation facilities include: Flush or pour flush to piped sewer system, septic tank or pit latrine, ventilated improved pit latrine, pit latrine with slab and composting toilet. However, sanitation facilities are not considered improved when shared with other households, or open to public use. While, unimproved sanitation include: Flush or pour flush to elsewhere, pit latrine without slab or open pit, bucket, hanging toilet or hanging latrine and no facilities or bush or field (open defecation).

DATA AND METHODS

This factsheet uses data from the Kiribati population and housing census 2020. The six variables from the WG short set on functioning were combined to identify the population with disabilities. Individuals aged 5 years and older who had reported at least one domain as "a lot of difficulty" or "cannot do it at all" were identified as having disabilities, in accordance with the recommendations of the WG (Washington Group, 2009). Data were disaggregated by disability status, for the comparison of people with and without disabilities, a necessary step towards addressing disparities. The Chi-Square Test of Independence have been carried out to examine that the sets of variables are likely to be related with each other or not (significance level $p < 0.05$).

For further information

Kiribati disability monograph

(<https://www.spc.int/digitalibrary/get/rtiav>)

Pacific disability dashboard

(<https://pacificdata.org/disability-dashboard>)

WG definition and methods

(<https://www.washingtongroup-disability.com/question-sets/wg-short-set-on-functioning-wg-ss/>)